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Initial Post

by Mariam Ibrahim Ismail Hasan Almarzooqi - Thursday, 11 December 2025, 7:56 AM

The case involving Abi presents a significant ethical dilemma relating to data integrity and the responsible use of statistics. Although outright fabrication of data is unethical, selectively presenting only positive results can be equally damaging. Bouaziz, Brulin, and Campo (2022) emphasize that misinterpreting or manipulating findings, whether intentionally or through selective disclosure, can mislead stakeholders and distort perceptions of a product's effectiveness. In Abi's case, pressure to highlight only favorable outcomes raises concerns about the research's transparency and accuracy.

Researchers have a professional responsibility to report results honestly, even when the outcomes do not meet the expectations of sponsors or manufacturers. According to Salonen (2024), ethical research requires openness and truthfulness to maintain public trust and protect consumers. Omitting negative findings weakens scientific credibility and may expose the public to risks, especially in fields related to health or nutrition.

Furthermore, presenting only positive data could result in reputational and legal consequences for Abi. If the manufacturer publishes selectively favorable results, Abi may be seen as complicit in misleading consumers. Kitchen and Tourky (2022) highlight that misrepresentation in product communication can lead to penalties, including lawsuits and fines. Therefore, Abi should advocate for full disclosure of both positive and negative results. If the company insists on selective reporting, withdrawing from the project may be necessary to preserve ethical integrity.

References:

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